International — Summits, Bilateral, UN, Elections

> **Priority S** | About **22%** of Current Affairs questions In 2024–25 papers, many of these were tagged as **International Relations**, not only "Current Affairs".

What to note every time

Before you finish reading any international news, answer these in simple words:

Ask yourself	Why
Where was it held?	City and country
Who went from India?	PM, President, External Affairs Minister, or someone else
What was decided?	Treaty, MoU, declaration, project
Is it binding?	Must follow, or only a promise
Any neighbour / trade angle?	Pipeline, bus, FTA, UPI, defence deal
Org head or membership?	HQ, chief, or "who is **not** a member"

High-Yield International Summits Foundation (2024–2025 Spine)

> **UPPCS Priority Alert:** International summits, host venues, themes, membership expansions, and declaration names form ~22% of CA questions. Memorise these core institutional anchors.

1. 16th BRICS Summit (October 2024 | Kazan, Russia)

- **Host City & President:** Kazan, Tatarstan (Russia); chaired by Russian President Vladimir Putin.
- **Theme:** *"Strengthening Multilateralism for Just Global Development and Security"*.
- **Historic Expansion:** First summit held after the formal induction of new full members: **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and UAE** (Saudi Arabia participated as invited nation; Argentina opted out under Javier Milei).
- **Outcome Document: Kazan Declaration** — reiterated call for reforming the UN Security Council, promoting local currency settlements (BRICS Pay / Cross-Border Payment Initiative), and condemning unilateral coercive measures.
- **Partner Country Category:** Introduced 13 new "Partner Countries" (e.g., Turkey, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Vietnam, Belarus, Cuba, Nigeria, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Bolivia, Algeria).
- **India–China Bilateral Breakthrough:** PM Narendra Modi and President Xi Jinping held their first formal bilateral summit in 5 years on the sidelines, endorsing the border patrolling pact along the LAC in eastern Ladakh (Depsang and Demchok).

2. 19th G20 Leaders' Summit (November 2024 | Rio de Janeiro, Brazil)

- **Host City & Chair:** Rio de Janeiro, Brazil; chaired by Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva.
- **Theme:** *"Building a Just World and a Sustainable Planet"*.
- **Key Initiative:** Formal launch of the **Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty** (founded with over 80 countries, international organisations, and development banks).
- **G20 Troika Transition: India (2023) → Brazil (2024) → South Africa (2025)** — the first historic Troika composed consecutively of developing economies (Global South). Handover of G20 gavel to South African President Cyril Ramaphosa for the 2025 summit.
- **Rio Declaration:** Emphasized taxing ultra-high-net-worth individuals, climate finance, and accelerating reform of the international financial architecture.

3. UNFCCC COP29 Climate Summit (November 2024 | Baku, Azerbaijan)

- **Host City & Chair:** Baku, Azerbaijan; chaired by Mukhtar Babayev.

- **Known as:** The **"Finance COP"**.
- **NCQG (New Collective Quantified Goal):** Replaced the outdated $100 billion annual climate finance goal. Adopted a new target: developed countries to lead in mobilizing at least **$300 billion annually by 2035** for developing nations (developing nations termed the amount grossly inadequate compared to their estimated $1.3 trillion annual need).
- **Article 6 Carbon Markets:** Finalized long-delayed operational rules for **Article 6.4 of the Paris Agreement**, paving the way for a centralized, UN-supervised international carbon credit trading market.
- **Next COP Host: COP30** to be hosted in **Belém, Brazil (November 2025)** in the Amazon biome.

3A. India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) | MoU at G20 New Delhi, September 2023

What happened Partners signed an MoU to build **IMEC**, a multimodal corridor linking **India, the Arabian Gulf, and Europe**.

Core facts

- **East corridor:** India ↔ Arabian Gulf (mainly **maritime**).
- **Northern corridor:** Gulf ↔ Europe (mainly **rail**, then Mediterranean sea legs).
- Founding participants include **India, USA, UAE, Saudi Arabia, EU, France, Germany, Italy**. **China is not a founding participant.**
- Also envisaged: power cables, digital links, and clean hydrogen pipes along the route.

> **Trap**

Do not put China in the founding MoU list. IMEC is often contrasted with China's Belt and Road Initiative, but China is not a founder.

3B. India elected to ECOSOC | June 2025 | term 2026–28

What happened The UN General Assembly elected **India** to the **Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)** for **2026–28**.

Core facts

- Election is by **regional groups**. India won under the **Asia-Pacific** group (**181 / 187** valid votes).
- Term begins **1 January 2026**.
- ECOSOC has **54** members elected for **three-year** terms.
- ECOSOC is a **principal organ** of the UN. It is **not** a subsidiary body of the Security Council.

Preeti Saran re-elected to CESCR | April 2026 news window

What happened Former Indian diplomat **Preeti Saran** was **re-elected** to the UN **Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (CESCR)**.

Core facts

- CESCR monitors the **International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights**.
- Members serve in a **personal capacity** (expert body), not as country delegates in the usual diplomatic sense.
- She has also served as **Chair** of CESCR (first Indian in that chair in recent coverage).
- Term cited in 2026 election coverage: **2027–2030**.

> **Trap**

CESCR ≠ ECOSOC membership itself. Name trap: **Preeti Saran**, not Ruchira Kamboj.

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4. 50th G7 Summit (June 2024 | Apulia / Fasano, Italy)

- **Host:** Borgo Egnazia, Fasano, Apulia (Italy); chaired by Italian PM Giorgia Meloni.
- **India's Participation:** PM Narendra Modi attended as an **Invited Outreach Nation** (his first foreign visit after taking oath for his third term).
- **Key Outcome:** Agreement to provide a **$50 billion loan to Ukraine** backed by the interest/windfall profits from frozen Russian sovereign assets. Launched the Energy Growth in Africa initiative.

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5. UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage Session (December 2025 | New Delhi)

- **Venue & Chair:** 20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage held at **Red Fort, New Delhi** (8–13 December 2025); chaired by **Vishal V. Sharma** (India's Permanent Delegate to UNESCO).
- **Landmark Inscription: Deepavali** was inscribed on the **UNESCO Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity**.
- **India's Total Count:** Increased to **16** intangible cultural heritage elements inscribed on UNESCO's list.

January 2026

India–EU leaders' meeting | 27 January 2026 | New Delhi

What happened The President of the European Council, **António Costa**, and the President of the European Commission, **Ursula von der Leyen**, visited India. They held a summit-style meeting with Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**. The visit produced a long list of agreements. For the , you do not need every line. You need the big decisions and the easy traps.

Free Trade Agreement (FTA)

- India and the EU said they have **finished negotiations** on the **India–EU Free Trade Agreement**.
- Official messages called it India's **largest FTA** with a big partner market.
- Finishing talks is **not** the same as the deal already being in force. Signature and ratification come later.
- Sensitive areas such as **dairy** and some **auto** items were described as protected in public briefings. Do not memorise fake duty tables until a clear official factsheet is locked.

Other major outcomes

- Both sides adopted a long-term plan titled **Towards 2030: A Joint India–European Union Comprehensive Strategic Agenda**.
- They signed a **Security and Defence Partnership**.
- They started talks on an India–EU **Security of Information Agreement**.
- They signed an MoU on **mobility** (skills, students, professionals). An EU **pilot Legal Gateway Office** in India was also announced.
- India's **NDMA** and the EU's disaster body **DG-ECHO** signed an arrangement on disaster risk management and emergency response.
- A **Green Hydrogen Task Force** was set up.
- The India–EU science and technology cooperation agreement was renewed for **2025–2030**.
- Exploratory talks began on India linking with the EU research programme **Horizon Europe**.
- Four joint projects under India–EU trilateral cooperation were announced (digital skills for women and youth; solar help for women farmers; early warning systems; solar energy support for Africa and small island states).

> **Easy wrong options**

Mixing up **António Costa** and **Ursula von der Leyen**. Saying the FTA is **already in force** on 27 January. Saying NDMA partnered with **NATO** instead of **DG-ECHO**.

Same news for Economy notes

Trade numbers and the **RBI–ESMA** MoU are also kept under Economy / Budget / Trade.

February 2026

India–AI Impact Summit 2026 | 16–20 February 2026 | Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

What happened India hosted a big global Artificial Intelligence summit at **Bharat Mandapam** in New Delhi. Official notes call it the first major global AI summit of this kind held in the **Global South**. The Ministry of Electronics and IT / IndiaAI ecosystem anchored the event.

Core facts

- Dates: **16 to 20 February 2026**.
- Venue: **Bharat Mandapam**, New Delhi.
- The summit's three pillars (called **Sutras**) are **People**, **Planet**, and **Progress**.
- Some PIB notes also used a **Seven Chakras** framing for AI action areas. For prelims, first remember the three Sutras; add Chakras only if a stem asks.
- About **86 countries** supported the summit declaration (some briefings also mention international organisations).
- The message stressed **human-centred AI** and "welfare of all".
- Summit wrap-ups spoke of infrastructure investment pledges above **250 billion US dollars**, plus extra venture and deep-tech money.
- India joined the US-led **Pax Silica Declaration**. This is about safer supply chains for critical minerals, semiconductors, and AI infrastructure.
- The closing days included **GPAI Council** meetings (noted around **20 February**).

> **Easy wrong options**

Writing the venue as Hyderabad or Mumbai. Calling it the "first AI meeting in world history". Forgetting **People–Planet–Progress**.

Link to awards

The **Global Teacher Prize 2026** was announced around the same February window at the World Governments Summit in Dubai. Full card → Awards.

March 2026

WTO Ministerial Conference 14 (MC14) | Yaoundé, Cameroon

What happened The World Trade Organization held its **14th Ministerial Conference** in **Yaoundé**, Cameroon. It was only the second WTO ministerial meeting held in Africa. The meeting ended **without** a big binding deal on several hard issues.

Core facts

- Place: **Yaoundé**, Cameroon.
- E-commerce customs duty moratorium talks did not produce a lasting deal that all sides accepted in the way many countries wanted.
- India, along with partners such as South Africa in coverage, opposed pushing the **Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD)** agreement in the way some members wanted.
- Basic WTO memory: HQ **Geneva**; Director-General **Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala**.

> **Easy wrong options**

Saying a full IFD deal was approved with India's support. Writing the venue as Geneva instead of Yaoundé.

Global Terrorism Index 2026 | Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)

What happened The **Global Terrorism Index 2026** said **Pakistan** ranked **number one** for the first time in this report's recent pattern. Global terrorism deaths were reported to have fallen, while the **Sahel** region remained a major hotspot.

Core facts

- Publisher: **IEP**.
- Top country in 2026 edition messaging: **Pakistan**.
- Also revise: IEP publishes the **Global Peace Index** too.

April 2026

India–Republic of Korea Summit | 20–21 April 2026

What happened Republic of Korea Prime Minister **Lee Jae-myung** made a state visit to India on **20–21 April 2026**. Talks focused on making the Special Strategic Partnership more practical, with MoUs and work plans on industry and defence.

Core facts

- Partner country: **Republic of Korea (South Korea)**.
- Visit window: **20–21 April 2026**.
- Key areas named in coverage: shipbuilding, semiconductors, EV batteries, defence co-development, and a climate / clean-energy pillar.
- Both sides spoke of a time-bound review of the India–Korea **CEPA** (in force since **2010**).
- A high-profile visit stop named in coverage: **Lothal National Maritime Heritage Complex**, Gujarat.

> **Easy wrong options**

Writing "first ever India–Korea CEPA signed in April 2026". CEPA is old; April 2026 was about **review**, not a brand-new deal from zero.

UNSC vote on the Strait of Hormuz

What happened The UN Security Council voted on a resolution about reopening the **Strait of Hormuz**, a key oil shipping choke point. **Russia** and **China** used their veto.

Core facts

- Vote pattern in coverage: **11** in favour, **2** against (Russia, China), **2** abstentions.
- The resolution was associated with a Bahrain-led proposal in compilations.
- Soft follow-up: mediation and ceasefire talk involving **Pakistan** and failed US–Iran peace talks also appeared in April IR coverage.

Soft law facts from abroad

- The UK Parliament passed the **Tobacco and Vapes Bill** path that blocks cigarette sales for people born on or after **1 January 2009**.
- **Turkey** tightened social-media access rules for children under **15**.

9th Indian Ocean Conference (IOC 2026) | 10–12 April 2026

- **Host Country: Mauritius**.
- **Theme: *"Collective Stewardship for Indian Ocean Governance"***.
- **Significance:** Organised in collaboration with India Foundation to address maritime security, blue economy, and ecological resilience across the Indian Ocean Region.

May 2026

Saudi Arabia joins International Big Cat Alliance | 22 May 2026

What happened Saudi Arabia joined the India-led **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** as the **26th** member country. Coverage called it the first Arab country on the platform.

Core facts

- New member: **Saudi Arabia** (26th).
- Alliance focus: seven big cats — tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, jaguar, and puma.
- India is home to **five** of these (not jaguar or puma).
- HQ of IBCA: **New Delhi**.
- Seed funding memory from older notes: about **₹150 crore** for 2023–2028.

Santa Marta Climate Conference | Colombia

What happened The first international conference on **transitioning away from fossil fuels** was held in **Santa Marta, Colombia**. It was co-hosted by **Colombia** and the **Netherlands**.

Core facts

- Place: **Santa Marta**.
- Theme focus: moving away from fossil fuels.
- Soft follow-up: France's fuel-by-fuel exit roadmap (coal by 2030, oil by 2045, gas by 2050) appeared in the same news window.

PM Modi's foreign civilian honours

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** received high civilian honours from Nordic countries during May coverage of his visit window.

Core facts

- **Norway:** Grand Cross of the **Royal Norwegian Order of Merit**.
- **Sweden: Royal Order of the Polar Star**, Commander Grand Cross.

UAE Formally Withdraws from OPEC | 1 May 2026

What happened The **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** formally withdrew its membership from the **Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)** with effect from **1 May 2026**, shifting its focus toward sovereign production quota flexibility and green transition partnerships.

June 2026

52nd G7 Summit | Évian-les-Bains, France | 15–17 June 2026

What happened The **52nd G7 Summit** was hosted by **France** at **Évian-les-Bains**, under the presidency of French President **Emmanuel Macron**. Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** represented India as an invited partner nation.

Core facts - **Venue: Évian-les-Bains, France**. - **Theme: *"Working Together to Address Major International Challenges"***. - **Key Outcome:** Adoption of the *Leaders' Declaration on Tackling Migrant Smuggling*. - **Initiatives:** Japanese PM Sanae Takaichi introduced the *POWERR Asia* initiative. - **G7 members:** Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the UK, and the USA.

16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers' Meeting | 12–13 June 2026

- **Host Venue: Indore, Madhya Pradesh** (held under India's BRICS Presidency).
- **Declaration Adopted: *Indore Declaration*** on sustainable agriculture, digital farming, and smallholder resilience.

Multilateral Institutional Expansions (June 2026)

- **New Development Bank (NDB): Uzbekistan** admitted as the **10th member country** of NDB.
- **UN General Assembly (UNGA) 81st Session:** Ambassador **Khalilur Rahman** of **Bangladesh** was elected President of the 81st UNGA session (term begins 8 September 2026), defeating Andreas Kakouris of Cyprus.

US–Iran interim pact | Islamabad MoU

What happened Coverage spoke of a **14-point** interim understanding called the **Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding**, mediated by **Pakistan**, linked with talks around the G7 window. It aimed to pause hostilities and open a negotiation window on nuclear and sanctions issues.

Soft facts

- Mediator often named: **Pakistan**.
- Nuclear monitoring body named: **IAEA**.
- Treat exact clauses carefully; stems may twist who lifts what.

Operation Amistad | Venezuela HADR

What happened India launched **Operation Amistad**, a Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief mission after earthquakes in **Venezuela**.

Core facts

- Two IAF **C-17 Globemaster** aircraft in early coverage.
- A rescue team of about **41** members was reported.
- Aim: relief supplies and rescue support.

PM Modi's June foreign honours

- **Slovakia: Order of the White Double Cross**, First Class (highest state honour).
- **Seychelles: Guardian of the Blue Horizon** (environment / sustainable development distinction in coverage).

IBCA Summit postponed

The first **International Big Cat Alliance** Summit planned for about **1–2 June** in New Delhi was **rescheduled** so African partners could join more fully (linked with India–Africa Forum Summit timing). Theme planned for the summit: **Save Big Cats, Save Humanity, Save Ecosystem**. Expected outcome named earlier: a **Delhi Declaration**.

India–Oman CEPA | in force early June 2026

What happened The **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** came into force around **1–2 June 2026**. It deepens trade with Oman in West Asia.

Easy facts

- Partner: **Oman**.
- Deal type: **CEPA** (trade partnership).
- Indian exports get duty-free access on about **99%** of trade value in explainers (up from a much smaller MFN share).
- Soft follow-up: about **7.5 lakh** Indians live in Oman in older population notes; bilateral trade is often put near **USD 12 billion**.

July 2026

India–UK CETA and Double Contribution Convention | in force 15 July 2026

What happened The India–UK **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** came into force on **15 July 2026**. On the same day, the companion social-security deal called the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)** also began.

Core facts

- Trade deal name: **CETA** (also called the UK–India FTA).
- Force date: **15 July 2026**.
- Signed earlier: **24 July 2025** in London.
- About **99%** of Indian goods entering the UK get zero or lower duty in coverage; about **90%** of UK goods entering India get relief in UK messaging.
- **DCC** is separate: workers and employers pay social security in only one country for a period. Exemption period raised to **5 years** in Indian messaging.
- Do not call CETA and DCC the same agreement.

> **Easy wrong options**

Writing that CETA is the Double Contribution Convention. Mixing force date with the July 2025 signing date.

PM Modi's Indonesia honour

- Indonesia conferred the **Bintang Adipurna** (highest civilian honour) on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**.
- Linked with the India–Indonesia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

Soft UK politics fact

- **Andy Burnham** became UK Prime Minister in late July coverage after replacing Keir Starmer as Labour leader.

France social-media age ban

- France passed a bill barring children under **15** from social media (first EU country with a blanket ban in coverage). Encyclopaedias and educational sites stay open.

August 2026

PM Modi receives Uzbekistan's highest state award

What happened In Tashkent, President **Shavkat Mirziyoyev** conferred Uzbekistan's supreme state award on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**.

Core facts

- Award name: **Order of Oliy Darajali Dustlik**.
- Place: **Tashkent**, Uzbekistan.

Soft Hormuz and Nauru notes

- **Iran** and **Oman** agreed in coverage to reopen the **Strait of Hormuz** for about **60 days**, with inbound traffic near Iran and outbound near Oman.
- Pacific island **Nauru** changed its official name to the **Republic of Naoero** (code **NRO** in coverage). It remains among the world's smallest countries.

Soft grassland guide at UNCCD COP17

India launched the first **Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems of India** at the **17th** session of **UNCCD COP17** in **Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**. Full soft environment card → Environment.

In-Depth Bilateral Relations & State Visits (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

1. India–Cyprus Strategic Partnership (20–23 May 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: President **Nikos Christodoulides** paid an official State Visit to India (his first visit in his current capacity).
- **Elevation of Ties**: Bilateral relations formally elevated to a **Strategic Partnership**.
- **Diplomatic Milestone**: Commemorates the upcoming **65th anniversary of diplomatic relations in 2027**.
- **Defence Roadmap**: Agreed on a 5-year roadmap for defence cooperation (**2026–2031**) between Cyprus Defence & Space Industries Cluster and Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM).
- **Financial & Space Integration**:
- MoU between **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** and **Eurobank Cyprus**.
- Framework established for interoperability of India's **UPI** with the **TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS)** of the European Central Bank.
- Space cooperation between **ERATOSTHENES Centre of Excellence** and **IN-SPACe**.

2. Myanmar President U Min Aung Hlaing Visit to India (30 May – 3 June 2026)

- **Significance**: First foreign trip undertaken by Myanmar President **U Min Aung Hlaing** since assuming office.
- **Foreign Policy Anchors**: Anchored under India's **"Neighbourhood First"** and **"Act East"** policies.
- **Spiritual & Tech Stops**:
- Offered prayers at **Mahabodhi Temple** (Bodh Gaya), Mahabodhi Meditation Centre, and Sujata Temple.
- Toured the **NTPC Energy Technology Research Alliance (NETRA)** complex in Greater Noida (UP) to observe clean energy and green hydrogen R&D.
- **Connectivity Projects Reaffirmed**:
- **Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project (KMMTTP)**: Connects Kolkata to **Sittwe Port** in Myanmar $\rightarrow$ inland waterway along Kaladan River to **Paletwa** $\rightarrow$ highway to **Zorinpui in Mizoram**.
- **India–Myanmar–Thailand (IMT) Trilateral Highway**: Critical land route connecting Northeast India to ASEAN.

3. India–South Korea "Futuristic Partnership" (19–21 April 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: South Korean President **Lee Jae-myung** held summit talks with PM Modi at Hyderabad House, New Delhi.
- **Framework**: Special Strategic Partnership (established in 2015) upgraded towards a *"futuristic partnership"*.
- **Key Bilateral Outcomes**:
- **Bilateral Trade Target**: Set at **USD 54 billion by 2030** (currently ~$27 billion).
- **Economic Security Dialogue**: Initiated to secure critical technologies and resilient semiconductor supply chains.
- **India–Korea Digital Bridge**: Focus on AI, semiconductors, and digital infrastructure.
- **Defence**: Shipbuilding and naval infrastructure (highlighted by the proven **K-9 Vajra** self-propelled howitzer partnership).
- **Cultural**: **2028–29** officially declared the **"Year of India–ROK Friendship"**.

4. India–Jordan Bilateral Milestone (15–16 December 2025)

- **Significance**: PM Narendra Modi paid an official visit to Amman; **first full-fledged bilateral visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Jordan in 37 years**.
- **Milestone**: Marked **75 years of diplomatic relations** with King Abdullah II ibn Al Hussein.
- **8-Point Vision**: Encompasses trade, fertilizers, IT, healthcare, infrastructure, critical minerals, civil nuclear cooperation, and people-to-people ties.
- **Food Security Strategic Anchor**: Jordan supplies vital **phosphates and potash fertilisers** essential for India's agricultural security.
- **Agreements Signed**: 5 MoUs covering renewable energy, water management, cultural exchange, heritage twinning, and Digital Public Infrastructure (including proposed UPI integration).

5. India–UAE Comprehensive Strategic Outcomes (Jan & May 2026)

- **Summit Meetings**: UAE President **Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan (MBZ)** visited India on 19 January 2026; PM Modi visited UAE in May 2026 (kick-starting a 5-nation tour).
- **Strategic Petroleum Reserves (SPR)**:
- Strategic Collaboration MoU between **Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited (ISPRL)** and **Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC)**.
- Provides for potential ADNOC crude storage up to **30 million barrels** in India's SPR facilities at **Visakhapatnam (AP)** and the upcoming reserve at **Chandikhol (Odisha)**.
- Includes provision for potential Indian crude oil storage at **Fujairah (UAE)**.
- **Maritime & Supercomputing Hubs**:
- MoU between **Cochin Shipyard Limited** and **Drydocks World** to establish a **Ship Repair Cluster at Vadinar (Gujarat)** with offshore fabrication under the Maritime Development Fund Scheme.
- Term sheet signed between **C-DAC (India)** and **G42 (UAE)** to establish an **8-exaflop supercomputing cluster**.
- Operationalised the Virtual Trade Corridor using **MAITRI** (*Master Application for International Trade and Regulatory Interface*).
- **Trade & Energy**:
- **HPCL–ADNOC Gas Agreement**: 10-year Sale and Purchase Agreement (SPA) for **0.5 MMTPA LNG** starting 2028.
- Development of **Dholera Special Investment Region (SIR)** in Gujarat with UAE partnership.
- Setting up of **DP World** and **First Abu Dhabi Bank (FAB)** in **GIFT City**.
- Establishment of **"House of India"** in Abu Dhabi (museum of Indian art and heritage); UAE providing artefacts for the **National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC) at Lothal**.

6. India–Afghanistan Engagement & Mission Upgrade (October 2025)

- **High-Level Visit**: Afghan Acting Foreign Minister **Amir Khan Muttaqi** visited India (9–16 October 2025) — highest-level engagement since the Taliban takeover in August 2021.
- **Diplomatic Status**: India upgraded its technical mission in Kabul to a **full-fledged operational embassy** and allowed Taliban-appointed diplomats to staff the Afghan Embassy in New Delhi.
- **Air Corridor**: Agreed to relaunch the **India–Afghanistan Air Freight Corridor**.
- **Development Portfolio**: India remains one of Afghanistan's largest development partners with over **$3 billion** in developmental assistance across 34 provinces.

7. India–Mongolia 70-Year Milestone (14 October 2025)

- **Summit**: PM Modi and Mongolian President **Khurelsukh Ukhnaa** held bilateral talks in New Delhi, marking **70 years of diplomatic relations** (established 1955).
- **Strategic Partnership**: Upgraded in 2015 under a $1 billion credit line.
- **Oil Refinery Project**: Reaffirmed the **$1.7 billion oil refinery project** (Mongolia's first refinery, 1.5 MMTPA capacity by 2028, built with Indian support).
- **Cultural & Regional Link**:
- Regional partnership: **Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council $\leftrightarrow$ Arkhangai Province**.
- India to digitise **1 million Mongolian manuscripts** and deploy a Sanskrit teacher to **Gandan Monastery**.
- Free e-visas announced for Mongolian citizens; 2026 visit of Arahant Buddhist relics to Mongolia.
- **Conservation**: Mongolia officially joined India's **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)**.

8. Sri Lankan PM Dr. Harini Nireka Amarasuriya Maiden Visit (16–18 October 2025)

- **Significance**: Dr. Harini Nireka Amarasuriya's first official overseas visit after assuming office as Prime Minister.
- **Education & Heritage Connect**: Visited her alma mater **Hindu College (Delhi University)**, where she previously studied Sociology under an Indian MEA scholarship.
- **Key Agendas**: Advanced negotiations on the **Economic and Technology Cooperation Agreement (ETCA)** and studied India's **PM Gati Shakti** and **NEP 2020** models at NITI Aayog.
- **Bharat–Sri Lanka Sanskrit Mahotsav**: Inaugurated on **10 November 2025** at the University of Colombo, organized by Swami Vivekananda Cultural Centre, Central Sanskrit University (India), and SL Ministry of Education.

9. India–Vietnam Academic & Tech Cooperation (18 September 2025)

- **MoU**: **IIT Kanpur** and **Vietnam National University (VNU)** signed a major research MoU in Kanpur.
- **Focus Areas**: AI, smart city engineering, autonomous drone technology, and digital healthcare.

10. India–Russia Bilateral Meeting (1 September 2025 | SCO Tianjin)

- **Context**: PM Narendra Modi and President Vladimir Putin met on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Tianjin, China.
- **Pact & Trade**: Reaffirmed the **"Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership"**. Bilateral trade reached **US$ 68.72 billion in FY 2024–25** (dominated by energy imports). PM Modi invited Putin for the 23rd Annual India–Russia Summit in India.

11. India–Maldives 60th Independence Day (25–26 July 2025)

- **Historic First**: PM Modi was the **Guest of Honour at Maldives' 60th Independence Day** — the **first-ever Indian PM** to be invited as Chief Guest. Marked **60 years of diplomatic ties** (1965–2025).
- **Trade Deal**: Formally launched negotiations for the **India–Maldives Free Trade Agreement (IMFTA)**.
- **Financial Package**: Extended a **Line of Credit (LoC) of INR 4,850 crore (~USD 550 million)** along with eased debt rollover.
- **Handover**: 3,300 social housing units in Hulhumalé; new Ministry of Defence building; Colombo Security Conclave equipment handed to MNDF.
- **Joint Stamps**: Depicting traditional seafaring heritage: Indian **'Uru'** and Maldivian **'Vadhu Dhoni'**.

12. India–Philippines Strategic Partnership (4–8 August 2025)

- **Dignitary**: Philippine President **Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.** paid his first State Visit to India, marking **75 years of diplomatic ties** (established 1949).
- **Elevation of Ties**: Upgraded to a **Strategic Partnership** via the *Strategic Partnership Plan of Action (2025–2029)*.
- **Treaties Signed**: 1. **MLAT**: Mutual Legal Assistance in Criminal Matters. 2. **TTSP**: Transfer of Sentenced Persons.
- **Trade & Space**: Adopted Terms of Reference (ToR) for a **Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA)** (trade stood at ~$3.3 billion in 2024–25); ISRO and Philippine Space Agency signed a Statement of Intent.
- **Joint Stamps**: Featuring the national flowers: Indian **Lotus** and Philippine **Sampaguita** (a fragrant Arabian jasmine variety).

13. India–Canada Strategic Energy & Uranium Pact (27 Feb – 2 March 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: Canadian Prime Minister **Mark Carney** paid an official visit to India; marked **79 years of diplomatic relations**.

- **Cameco–DAE Deal**: Landmark **CAD 2.6 billion agreement** between Canadian uranium giant **Cameco** and India's **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)** for long-term supply of uranium to fuel India's civilian reactors.
- **CEPA Negotiations**: Signed Terms of Reference to conclude the **Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** by end-2026, aiming to raise bilateral trade to **CAD 70 billion (~INR 4.65 lakh crore) by 2030**.
- **Agri & Skilling Centers**:
- Proposal to establish the **Canada–India Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence** at **NIFTEM Kundli (Haryana)**.
- **AICTE–Mitacs MoU**: Funds research internships for **300 Indian undergraduate students annually** at Canadian universities starting 2027.
- **Critical Minerals**: Signed MoU on Critical Minerals Cooperation; India endorsed the G7 Critical Minerals Action Plan.

14. India–Brazil Strategic Ties (18–22 February 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: Brazilian President **Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva** paid his 2nd State Visit (5th overall visit) to India.
- **Multilateral Forum**: Attended the **2nd AI Impact Summit** (19–20 Feb) in New Delhi and held bilateral talks with PM Modi on 21 February.
- **Global South Anchors**: Reaffirmed joint leadership across **BRICS, G20, IBSA, G-4, WTO, and United Nations** reform.
- **Trade & Resources**: Shared target to raise bilateral trade to over **USD 30 billion by 2030** (Brazil is India's largest trading partner in Latin America). MoU between India's Ministry of Steel and Brazil's Ministry of Mines and Energy for steel sector minerals.
- **Modi's 2025 Visit**: On 8 July 2025, PM Modi was conferred Brazil's highest national honour: ***"The Grand Collar of the National Order of the Southern Cross"***.

15. India–Argentina (4–5 July 2025)

- **Historic Milestone**: First bilateral visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Argentina in **57 years** (Modi previously visited in 2018 for the multilateral G20 Summit).
- **Leadership**: Summit talks with President **Javier Milei** in Buenos Aires; Strategic Partnership (since 2019).
- **Tribute**: Paid homage at the memorial of **General José de San Martín** (*Father of the Nation of Argentina*).
- **Trade Linchpin**: Argentina is India's primary global supplier of **edible oils, especially soybean oil**.

16. India–Trinidad & Tobago (3–4 July 2025)

- **Summit & Honours**: PM Modi met President **Christine Carla Kangaloo** and was conferred the nation's highest honour: ***"The Order of the Republic"*** (first foreign leader to receive it).
- **First in Caribbean**: Trinidad & Tobago became the **first Caribbean country to adopt UPI** (agreement signed September 2024).
- **Diaspora Milestone**: Modi addressed the Joint Parliament and announced that **OCI card eligibility is extended to the 6th generation diaspora** (earlier capped at the 4th generation).

17. India–Norway & 3rd India–Nordic Summit (18–19 May 2026 | Oslo)

- **Elevation of Ties**: Bilateral relationship elevated to a ***"Green Strategic Partnership"*** during PM Modi's visit to Oslo, hosted by Norwegian PM **Jonas Gahr Støre** (audience with King Harald V).
- **3rd India–Nordic Summit (19 May 2026)**: Convened India alongside Norway, Denmark, Finland, Iceland, and Sweden; elevated to a *trusted Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership*.
- **Green Finance & IPOI**: Norwegian Climate Investment Fund investing in Indian clean energy under **Article 6.2 of Paris Agreement**; Norway officially joined the **Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)**; Arctic research at India's **Himadri station in Ny-Ålesund, Svalbard**.

18. India–Italy & FAO Agricola Medal (19–20 May 2026 | Rome)

- **Elevation of Ties**: Upgraded to a ***"Special Strategic Partnership"*** during PM Modi's bilateral talks with Italian PM **Giorgia Meloni**.
- **Motto**: *"Design and Develop in India and Italy, and Deliver for the World"*.
- **Trade & Security**: Bilateral trade target of **€20 billion by 2029**. Permanent Task Force on countering terror financing; MoU between Italy's **Guardia di Finanza** and India's **Directorate of Enforcement (ED)**.
- **Mobility & Culture**: Launched ***"ICI – Italy Calls India: a University-Enterprise Talent Bridge"***; **2027** declared *Year of Culture and Tourism between Italy and India*; Italy participating in NMHC Lothal.

- **FAO Agricola Medal**: PM Modi visited FAO Headquarters in Rome and received the **FAO Agricola Medal** (highest FAO award for food security and sustainable agrifood systems).

19. India–France (17–19 February 2026)

- **Elevation**: French President **Emmanuel Macron** visited India; ties upgraded to a ***"Special Global Strategic Partnership"*** under the *Horizon 2047 Roadmap*.
- **Innovation Year**: **India–France Year of Innovation 2026** focusing on AI, healthcare, and research.
- **Defence Manufacturing**: Deepening co-design and co-production (Rafale-M fighters, Scorpène submarines, and helicopter assembly in India).
- **Civil Nuclear**: France reaffirmed backing for India's 100 GW nuclear target by 2047, advancing the **Jaitapur Nuclear Power Project (Maharashtra)**.

20. India–Germany (12–13 January 2026)

- **Summit**: German Chancellor **Friedrich Merz** held bilateral talks with PM Modi in Gandhinagar / Ahmedabad.
- **Mobility Milestone**: Germany announced **visa-free transit** for Indian passport holders transiting through German airports.
- **Trade & Defence**: Bilateral trade crossed **USD 50 billion**. Germany showed active interest in naval and air exercises: **MILAN 2026, IONS Conclave of Chiefs, and Exercise Tarang Shakti**.

21. India–United Kingdom (8–9 October 2025)

- **UK PM Visit**: Prime Minister **Sir Keir Starmer** made his first official visit to India under the *Vision 2035* roadmap.
- **Defence Procurement**: Signed a **£350 million ($468 million)** contract for supply of lightweight missiles to India.
- **Tech & Innovation**: Launched the **India–U.K. Connectivity & Innovation Centre** (£24 million over 4 years across AI telecom, non-terrestrial networks, and cybersecurity); Critical Minerals Industry Guild launched with a satellite campus at **IIT-ISM Dhanbad**.
- **Foreign University Campuses**: Letter of Intent granted to **Lancaster University** to open a campus in **Bengaluru**; in-principle approval to **University of Surrey** for a campus in **GIFT City**.

22. India–Australia Organic Mutual Recognition (24 September 2025)

- **MRA on Organic Products**: Signed at Vanijya Bhavan, New Delhi under the India–Australia ECTA.
- **Implementing Agencies**: **APEDA (India)** and **DAFF (Australia)**.
- **Coverage**: Enables mutual acceptance of organic standards for unprocessed plant products, processed plant foods, and wine, eliminating duplicate testing and securing 30–40% price premiums for organic farmers.

23. India–Ethiopia (16–17 December 2025 | Addis Ababa)

- **Historic Visit**: PM Modi paid the **first-ever bilateral visit by an Indian PM to Ethiopia**, holding talks with PM **Abiy Ahmed Ali** and addressing the Joint Session of the Ethiopian Parliament.
- **Highest Honour**: PM Modi was conferred Ethiopia's supreme honour: ***"Great Honour Nishan of Ethiopia"***.
- **Elevation**: Bilateral relations elevated to a **Strategic Partnership**.

24. India–Namibia (9 July 2025 | Windhoek)

- **Historic Visit**: First visit to Namibia by an Indian Prime Minister in **27 years**, hosted by President **Dr. Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah**.
- **Highest Honour**: Modi was conferred Namibia's highest civilian honour: ***"Order of the Most Ancient Welwitschia Mirabilis"*** (first Indian leader to receive it).
- **UPI Pioneer**: Namibia was the **first country globally to sign a licensing agreement to adopt UPI technology** (April 2024: NIPL and Bank of Namibia).
- **Global Initiatives**: Namibia joined the **Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI)** and the **Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)**.
- **Wildlife Diplomacy**: Acknowledged Namibia's foundational gift of **8 cheetahs in 2022** for the Cheetah Reintroduction Project at **Kuno National Park (Madhya Pradesh)**.

Global Geopolitics, West Asia Accord & Evacuation Operations

US–Iran Initial Peace Agreement (17 June 2026)

- **Signatories**: Signed electronically by US President **Donald Trump** and Iranian President **Masoud Pezeshkian** (14-point MoU) aimed at halting the 4-month West Asian war.
- **Key Terms**: 1. Immediate ceasefire across all fronts, explicitly including Lebanon. 2. **Strait of Hormuz Reopening**: Unrestricted, toll-free commercial passage restored within 30 days. 3. **Economic Sanctions Relief**: US Treasury waivers for Iranian crude, petroleum, and shipping. 4. **Reconstruction Fund**: Framework for a **$300 billion reconstruction fund** financed by Gulf Arab states (US will not contribute directly). 5. **Unfreezing Assets**: Unblocking ~$24 billion of restricted Iranian funds held abroad. 6. **Nuclear Enrichment Ceiling**: Iran required to halt enrichment and **down-blend existing highly enriched uranium stocks to 3.67%** under strict IAEA verification.

Military Operations in the Conflict

- **Joint US–Israeli Strikes (28 Feb 2026)**: US termed it **Operation Epic Fury**; airstrikes on Iranian nuclear sites (Fordow, Natanz, Isfahan) named **Operation Midnight Hammer** using B-2 stealth bombers; Israel termed it **Operation Roaring Lion**.
- **Iran's Retaliation**: Successive missile barrages designated **Operation True Promise 3**.
- **Gaza & Syria Operations**: Israel launched **Operation Gideon's Chariots II** in Gaza (Hamas responded with **Operation Moses' Staff**); Israel launched **Operation Arrow of Bashan** in Syria, declaring the 1974 Disengagement Agreement void.

IN Operation Sindhu (India's Evacuation Mission)

- **What is it**: The official overseas emergency evacuation operation launched by the **Government of India** to safely extract Indian citizens stranded across the war-affected West Asian theater.
- *(Historical Lineage: 1990–91 Gulf War airlift $\rightarrow$ Operation Sukoon 2006 Lebanon $\rightarrow$ Operation Safe Homecoming 2011 Libya $\rightarrow$ Operation Rahat 2015 Yemen $\rightarrow$ Operation Ganga 2022 Ukraine $\rightarrow$ Operation Kaveri 2023 Sudan $\rightarrow$ Operation Ajay 2023 Israel $\rightarrow$ Operation Sindhu 2026).*

Supreme Leader Succession in Iran

- Following the death of Ali Khamenei on 28 February 2026, his son **Mojtaba Khamenei** was selected and announced as the new **Supreme Leader of Iran** by the Assembly of Experts on **9 March 2026**.

Prime Minister Modi Honoured by Both Israel and Palestine

- **Historic Record**: PM Narendra Modi became the **first leader in global history to be conferred the highest state honours by both Israel and Palestine**:
- **Israel**: Conferred the ***Speaker of the Knesset Medal*** on **25 February 2026** (presented by Speaker Amir Ohana in Jerusalem).
- **Palestine**: Conferred the ***Grand Collar of the State of Palestine*** in **2018** (presented by President Mahmoud Abbas).

Arrest of Venezuelan President & Operation Absolute Resolve (January 2026)

- **What Happened**: Venezuelan President **Nicolás Maduro** was captured by U.S. forces during **Operation Absolute Resolve** in January 2026.
- **Acting Leadership**: Venezuela's Supreme Court directed Vice President **Delcy Rodríguez** (in office since 2018; Bolivarian socialist movement founded by Hugo Chávez) to assume the role of acting President.
- **Geopolitical & Legal Flashpoint**: Prompted international debates regarding state sovereignty, unilateral intervention, and **Article 2(4) of the UN Charter** (which strictly prohibits the threat or use of force against the territorial integrity or political independence of any state).

Multilateral Summits, Conferences & International Organisations (2025–2026)

1. 52nd G7 Summit (15–17 June 2026 | Évian-les-Bains, France)

- **Host & Presidency**: Held in **Évian-les-Bains, France**, under the French G7 Presidency.
- **Participants**: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, United Kingdom, United States, and the European Union.
- **Outreach Guests**: Key invited partners including **India** and Brazil.

- **India's Participation**: Marked **India's 13th guest invitation** and Prime Minister Narendra Modi's **7th consecutive appearance** at the G7 Summit.
- **Key Deliberations & Declarations**:
- Addressed vital waterway disruptions, endorsing demining operations and naval escort missions in the **Strait of Hormuz** for secure global energy transit.
- PM Modi strongly championed the safety of civilian seafarers and freedom of international commercial navigation.
- Reaffirmed peace and stability in the Taiwan Strait and called for complete, verifiable denuclearization of North Korea.
- Adopted three joint declarations: *Public Health & Tech*, *Migration & Crime*, and *Economy & Supply Chains*.
- **Chronology & Future Hosts**:
- **51st G7 Summit (2025)**: Kananaskis, Alberta, Canada.
- **52nd G7 Summit (2026)**: Évian-les-Bains, France.
- **53rd G7 Summit (2027)**: United States.

2. Election of the President of the 81st UNGA Session (September 2026)

- **Elected President**: **Khalilur Rahman**, veteran diplomat and Foreign Minister of **Bangladesh**, was elected President of the **81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)**.
- **Tenure**: Commences 1-year tenure on **8 September 2026**.
- **Election Process**: Elected through a secret ballot after contesting against Andreas Kakouris of Cyprus. The presidency was allocated to the **Asia-Pacific Group** under the UN's geographic rotation system.
- **Theme of the 81st Session**: *"Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations that Delivers for All"*.
- **Historical Benchmark**: This marks Bangladesh's second UNGA presidency; **Humayun Rasheed Choudhury** served as President of the 41st UNGA Session in **1986**.

3. 18th BRICS Leaders' Summit 2026 & India's chairship

What happened India hosted the **18th BRICS Summit** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi** on **12–13 September 2026** under its 2026 chairship.

What you should remember

- Chairship theme: **Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability**.
- Outcome document: **New Delhi Declaration** (adopted by leaders).
- MEA called the chairship year a "major success" with **over 50** action-oriented outcomes across meetings held in India.
- The Summit week also included a **BRICS Plus / Outreach** dialogue segment.
- India's BRICS Sherpa: **Sudhakar Dalela**.
- Chairship count: India's **fourth** BRICS chairship (**2012, 2016, 2021, 2026**).
- Preceding Summit: **17th BRICS Summit** in **Rio de Janeiro, Brazil** (6–7 July 2025).
- Earlier 2026 boards: BRICS Foreign Ministers' Meeting at Bharat Mandapam (**14–15 May 2026**); Agriculture Ministers' Meeting in **Indore** (**12–13 June 2026**).

> **Trap**

Do not park the 18th Summit in **Rio** or **Kazan**. Those are older venues. September 2026 = **New Delhi**.

3a. BRICS membership teaching note

- Expanded BRICS teaching set includes core five plus newer full members such as **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Indonesia** (and related accession / partner lanes as taught in class notes).
- For stems, prefer the Summit **host / theme / declaration name** over memorising every partner flag.

4. UNSC Non-Permanent Members Election (2027–2028 Term)

- **Election Date & Organ**: Elected by the UN General Assembly on **3 June 2026** for a two-year mandate running from **1 January 2027 to 31 December 2028**.
- **Five Elected Nations**:
- **Western European and Others Group (2 seats)**: **Austria** and **Portugal** (Germany secured 104 votes and failed to win a seat).

- **Asia-Pacific Group (1 seat)**: **Kyrgyzstan** (defeated the Philippines after four competitive voting rounds; marks Kyrgyzstan's **first-ever term** on the Security Council since joining the UN in 1992).
- **Latin America and Caribbean Group (1 seat)**: **Trinidad and Tobago**.
- **African Group (1 seat)**: **Zimbabwe**.

5. Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB) — India's Chairmanship

- **Leadership Role**: India was nominated to chair the **Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB)** for a **two-year term** (2026–2028), elevating India's voice in global cybersecurity governance.
- **Mandate**: CCDB is the governing body for the Common Criteria framework, standardizing global evaluation and certification of IT product security.
- **Benchmark Standard**: Governed under **ISO/IEC 15408** ("*Evaluation criteria for IT security*", latest edition **ISO/IEC 15408-1:2026**).

6. 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting (26 May 2026 | New Delhi)

- **Host & Participants**: Hosted by India in **New Delhi** on 26 May 2026, bringing together Foreign Ministers of **India, USA, Japan, and Australia**.
- **Four Core Cooperation Pillars**: 1. Maritime and transnational security. 2. Economic prosperity and security. 3. Critical and emerging technologies. 4. Humanitarian assistance and emergency response.
- **Major Outcomes & Agreements**:
- **IPMSC**: Established the *Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Collaboration* to enhance coordinated naval and satellite monitoring.
- **IPMDA Hub in India**: Welcomed the operationalisation of the Indian Ocean Region programme of the *Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness (IPMDA)* through the **Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR)** in **Gurugram, Haryana**.
- **Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security**: Launched to protect critical maritime energy lifelines and grid integration.
- **Quad Critical Minerals Framework**: Formulated to build transparent, resilient mineral supply chains, countering high concentration (IEA data shows China controls ~91% of global refined rare earth production).
- **Fiji Port Development**: Quad committed joint assistance to the Government of **Fiji** for modernising port infrastructure (following the *Quad Ports of the Future Partnership Conference* hosted by India in October 2025).
- **Pax Silica**: Formally incorporated into the Quad's economic security doctrine to guarantee semiconductor and trusted AI hardware supply ecosystems across 5G/6G and advanced computing.

7. WTO 14th Ministerial Conference (MC-14 | Yaoundé, Cameroon | March 2026)

- **Venue & Significance**: Held in **Yaoundé, Cameroon** — making it only the **second WTO Ministerial Conference ever hosted on African soil** (after MC-10 in Nairobi, Kenya, 2015).
- **Membership**: WTO comprises **166 member states**.
- **Indian Delegation**: Led by Union Minister of Commerce and Industry **Piyush Goyal**.
- **Key Impasse & Outcomes**:
- The conference failed to conclude a comprehensive consensus ministerial declaration due to sharp North–South divisions on WTO dispute settlement reform and agriculture.
- **E-Commerce Moratorium**: A critical flashpoint was the moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions (in force since 1998); members failed to agree on a permanent extension.
- **Fisheries Subsidies Agreement**: Noted that the landmark WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies officially **entered into force on 15 September 2025**.
- **India's Stance**: Firmly safeguarded public stockholding (PSH) for food security, protected subsidies for small and artisanal fishermen, and resisted disciplines on non-violation complaints under TRIPS.

8. 11th Raisina Dialogue 2026 (5–7 March 2026 | New Delhi)

- **Organisers**: Jointly hosted by the **Observer Research Foundation (ORF)** and the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**.
- **Theme**: "*Samskāra: Assertion, Accommodation, Advancement*".
- **Chief Guest & Keynote Speaker**: **Alexander Stubb**, President of **Finland**.
- **Inauguration**: Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi; attended by ~2,700 delegates from over 110 countries.

- **New Launch**: Unveiled the **Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative (SDI)**, institutionalised by the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) to the Government of India and ORF to bridge advanced science, quantum/AI technologies, and diplomatic policy.

9. 16th India–EU Summit (27 January 2026 | New Delhi)

- **High-Level Representation**: Prime Minister Narendra Modi met with European Council President **António Costa** and European Commission President **Ursula von der Leyen** (who were also Chief Guests for India's 77th Republic Day).
- **Historic FTA Milestone**: Formally announced the **successful conclusion of negotiations on the landmark India–EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** (negotiations originally launched in 2007, suspended in 2013, and re-launched in June 2022).
- **Strategic Roadmap**: Adopted the comprehensive ***"Towards 2030"*** strategic agenda structured across five pillars: 1. Prosperity and sustainability. 2. Technology and innovation. 3. Security and defence. 4. Connectivity and global challenges. 5. Mobility and people-to-people ties.
- **Defence & Security**: Launched the *India–EU Security and Defence Partnership* covering joint maritime security exercises, cybersecurity incident response, and defence industrial co-production.
- **Institutional MoUs**:
- Adopted a *Comprehensive Mobility Framework* for seamless movement of professionals, researchers, and students.
- Extended the *India–EU Science and Technology Agreement* for the **2025–2030** cycle; initiated discussions for India's associate membership in **Horizon Europe**.
- Disaster management cooperation pact between India's **NDMA** and EU's **DG-ECHO**.
- Dialogues on bridging carbon compliance regarding the EU's **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)**.

10. 20th G20 Leaders' Summit (22–23 November 2025 | Johannesburg, South Africa)

- **Historic Milestone**: The **first-ever G20 Leaders' Summit hosted on African soil**, held in Johannesburg under South Africa's G20 Presidency.
- **Summit Theme**: *"Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability"*.
- **Ubuntu Philosophy**: The *Johannesburg Leaders' Declaration* anchored itself in the traditional African humanist philosophy of **Ubuntu** (*"I am because we are" — shared humanity and mutual interdependence*).
- **Mission 300**: Pledged concerted multilateral support to provide electricity access to **300 million people across Africa by 2030**.
- **India's Six Global Proposals**: Prime Minister Narendra Modi (attending his 12th G20 Summit) proposed six major initiatives on behalf of the Global South: 1. *Traditional Knowledge Repository* (digitising indigenous medicinal and environmental knowledge). 2. *Africa Skills Multiplier Initiative* (pan-African vocational training through a train-the-trainer framework). 3. *Global Healthcare Response Team* (rapid emergency medical deployments). 4. *Open Satellite Data Partnership* (sharing Earth observation data for climate and agriculture). 5. *Critical Minerals Circularity Initiative* (recycling and sustainable processing). 6. *Drug–Terror Nexus Initiative* (combatting illicit narcotics trafficking financing terrorism).
- **Trilateral ACITI Launch**: On the summit sidelines (22 Nov 2025), India, Australia, and Canada officially launched the **Australia–Canada–India Technology and Innovation (ACITI) Partnership** focused on green energy, critical minerals supply chains, and responsible AI.
- **G20 Future Roster**:
- **21st G20 Summit (2026)**: Miami, Florida, United States.
- **22nd G20 Summit (2027)**: United Kingdom.
- **23rd G20 Summit (2028)**: Republic of Korea (South Korea).

11. 2nd WHO Global Summit on Traditional Medicine (17–19 December 2025 | New Delhi)

- **Host & Venue**: Co-hosted by the **World Health Organization (WHO)** and India's **Ministry of Ayush** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**.
- **Theme**: *"Restoring balance: The science and practice of health and well-being"*.
- **Institutional Background**: Followed the inaugural 1st WHO Global Summit on Traditional Medicine held in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat (August 2023)**.
- **Global Hub**: Anchored to the world's first and only global outpost dedicated to indigenous healing systems — the **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre (GTMC)** located at **Jamnagar, Gujarat**.

12. G7 French Presidency: One Health Summit 2026 (5–7 April 2026 | Lyon, France)

- **Host & Dates**: Convened in **Lyon, France**, coinciding with **World Health Day (7 April 2026)** under the French G7 Presidency.
- **Core Concept**: Focuses on the indivisible interconnections between human health, domestic and wild animal health, plant biosecurity, and ecosystem integrity (WHO notes that over **60% of all emerging human infectious pathogens originate in animals**).
- **Institutional Quadripartite**: Driven collectively by the four lead multilateral bodies: **WHO, FAO, UNEP, and WOAH** (World Organisation for Animal Health).

13. 22nd ASEAN–India Summit & 20th East Asia Summit (October 2025 | Kuala Lumpur)

- **Host & Presidency**: Held in **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**, chaired by Malaysian Prime Minister **Anwar Ibrahim** under Malaysia's 2025 ASEAN Chairship theme: *"Inclusivity and Sustainability"*.
- **India's Participation**: Prime Minister Narendra Modi participated virtually, reviewing the ASEAN–India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (established in 2022; relations began as sectoral dialogue partnership in 1992).
- **Major Strategic Initiatives**:
- Adopted the **ASEAN–India Plan of Action 2026–2030**.
- **India declared 2026 as the ASEAN–India Year of Maritime Cooperation**.
- Proposed the 2nd ASEAN–India Defence Ministers' Meeting and 2nd ASEAN–India Maritime Exercise.
- Announced specialized green energy training for 400 ASEAN professionals supporting the **ASEAN Power Grid**.
- Proposed establishing a **Centre for Southeast Asian Studies at Nalanda University** (Bihar).
- Announced the **East Asia Summit Maritime Heritage Festival at Lothal, Gujarat**.
- Endorsed the *ASEAN–India Joint Leaders' Statement on Sustainable Tourism*.
- **ASEAN Expansion**:
- **Timor-Leste** was officially admitted as the **11th member of ASEAN on 26 October 2025** during the summit in Kuala Lumpur (first new member admitted to ASEAN since the 1990s).
- **Subsequent Summits**:
- **20th East Asia Summit (EAS)**: Held on 27 October 2025 in Kuala Lumpur, marking 20 years since EAS inception via the 2005 Kuala Lumpur Declaration.
- **48th ASEAN Summit (8 May 2026)**: Held in **Cebu, Philippines**, under the Philippines' 2026 Chairship theme: *"Navigating Our Future, Together"*.

14. 25th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit 2025 (31 Aug–1 Sept 2025 | Tianjin)

- **Host City & Chair**: Held in **Tianjin, China**, attended in person by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- **Tianjin Declaration**: Strongly condemned international terrorism and, in a significant diplomatic breakthrough for New Delhi, explicitly named the **April 2025 Pahalgan terror attack in India**. Also condemned the Jaffer Express hijacking and Khuzdar school bus bombing.
- **SCO Structural Overhaul**: Merged dialogue partners and observers into a streamlined structure of **10 member states + 17 partners**, with **Laos** admitted as the newest partner.
- **New Institutional Organs**: Approved the establishment of four new specialized SCO centres (security, organized crime, cyber threats, drug trafficking) and initiated the formal creation of an **SCO Development Bank**.
- **Strategic Blueprints**: Adopted the *SCO Development Strategy 2026–2035*, *Cooperation Programme 2026–2030*, and the *Roadmap for Energy Cooperation till 2030*.
- **India–China Bilateral Side-Track**: Preceded by Chinese FM Wang Yi's visit to New Delhi (18–19 August 2025) for 24th Special Representatives (SR) talks with NSA Ajit Doval and EAM Dr. S. Jaishankar; agreed on expanding the **Kailash-Mansarovar Yatra (2026)** and resuming border trade through **Nathu La, Shipki La, and Lipulekh**.

15. World Food India (WFI) 2025 (25–28 September 2025 | New Delhi)

- **Venue & Host**: 4th edition held at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**, organised by the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) and inaugurated by PM Modi.
- **Partner Countries**: **New Zealand** and **Saudi Arabia**.
- **Focus Countries**: **Japan, UAE, Vietnam, and Russia**.
- **Scale**: Over 90 participating nations and 2,000+ exhibitors aimed at positioning India as a global food processing and value-addition hub.

16. India Elected to INTERPOL Asian Committee & Silver Notice Launch

- **Election (19 September 2025)**: India was elected as a member of the **INTERPOL Asian Committee** for a four-year term (**2025–2029**) during the 25th Asian Regional Conference in **Singapore**.
- **Nodal Agency**: India is represented by the **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)**, which operates as the National Central Bureau (NCB) for INTERPOL in India.
- **INTERPOL's 8 Color-Coded Notices Master Matrix**:
- **Red Notice**: Locates and arrests persons wanted for prosecution or to serve a sentence.
- **Yellow Notice**: Helps locate missing persons or identify persons unable to identify themselves.
- **Blue Notice**: Collects additional information on a suspect's identity, location, or activities.
- **Green Notice**: Warns of a person's criminal activities considered a potential threat.
- **Orange Notice**: Warns of an imminent event, person, or weapon threatening public safety.
- **Purple Notice**: Shares information on modi operandi, procedures, or concealing devices used by criminals.
- **Black Notice**: Seeks information on unidentified bodies.
- **Silver Notice (NEW — Launched January 2025)**: Specially designed to **identify, track, freeze, and confiscate criminal assets and illicit financial proceeds** across international jurisdictions! *(Critical UPPCS New Pattern Trap)*.

17. India–ILO Landmark MoU on IRCO (16 September 2025 | Geneva)

- **Pact**: India signed a historic MoU with the International Labour Organization (ILO) in Geneva to develop the **International Reference Classification of Occupations (IRCO)** to ensure global equivalence and mobility of Indian skilled workers.
- **Historical Anchor**: **N.M. Joshi** served as India's first representative of organized labour at the ILO's founding Washington Summit in **1919**.

International Elections & Head of State Transitions (2025–2026)

Country	Leader & Designation	Month / Year	Significance / Prelims Facts
Nepal	**Balendra Shah ("Balen")** (Prime Minister)	March 2026	Structural engineer, rapper, and former Mayor of Kathmandu; led the **Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP)** to victory following the **September 2025 "Gen Z Movement"** (triggered by a ban on 26 social media platforms and protests against nepotism / "Nepo Kids"). Became Nepal's **youngest Prime Minister** after the fall of K.P. Sharma Oli.
Nepal	**Sushila Karki** (Interim Prime Minister)	Late 2025	Former Chief Justice of Nepal; appointed as **interim Prime Minister** during the constitutional transition, becoming the **first female Prime Minister in Nepal's history**.
Japan	**Sanae Takaichi** (Prime Minister)	October 2025	Elected President of the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP) and designated by the Diet as the **104th Prime Minister of Japan** — becoming **Japan's first-ever female Prime Minister**.
Albania	**Diella** (Virtual Minister)	September 2025	**World's first AI-powered Minister** (*Diella* means "sun" in Albanian), integrated into the *e-Albania* digital governance portal to supervise public procurement and eliminate government tender corruption.
France	**Sebastien Lecornu** (Prime Minister)	September 2025	Appointed by President Emmanuel Macron following the resignation of François Bayrou after a National Assembly vote of no confidence.
Australia	**Anthony Albanese** (Prime Minister)	May 2025	Sworn in for a **second term** as Prime Minister of Australia on 13 May 2025.
Poland	**Karol Nawrocki** (President)	June 2025	Elected President of Poland (assumed office August 2025), succeeding Andrzej Duda after defeating Warsaw Mayor Rafal Trzaskowski.
Guyana	**Irfaan Ali** (President)	September 2025	Re-elected for a second presidential term; made history in 2020 as Guyana's first Muslim head of state.
Cameroon	**Paul Biya** (President)	October 2025	Re-elected for his **8th consecutive term** at the age of **92**, maintaining his status as the **world's oldest serving head of state**.

Global Disasters & Humanitarian Relief Operations (2025–2026)

1. Cyclone Ditwah & IN Operation Sagar Bandhu (November 2025)

- **Disaster**: Cyclone Ditwah triggered catastrophic flooding, storm surges, and landslides across **Sri Lanka** in late November 2025.
- **India's Response**: India immediately launched **Operation Sagar Bandhu** (*"Ocean Friend"*), reinforcing its role as First Responder in the Indian Ocean.
- **Assets Deployed**: Indian Navy deployed **INS Vikrant, INS Udaygiri, and INS Sukanya**, accompanied by Indian Air Force **C-130J Super Hercules** transport aircraft carrying field hospitals and relief stores.

2. Ethiopia's Hayli Gubbi Volcano Explosive Eruption (23 November 2025)

- **Location**: Located in the **Afar Depression / Erta Ale volcanic range** of the East African Rift System in Ethiopia.
- **Geological Milestone**: Erupted explosively on 23 November 2025, marking its **first documented explosive eruption in approximately 12,000 years**.
- **Impact**: Injected volcanic ash and sulphur dioxide plumes up to 15 km altitude, disrupting flight corridors across the Red Sea, Arabian Peninsula, and western India.

3. Hurricane Melissa (October 2025 | Jamaica)

- **Severity**: Landed on **Jamaica** as a catastrophic **Category 5 hurricane** with sustained winds of 295 km/h.
- **Record**: Officially became the **strongest hurricane ever recorded to strike Jamaica** in modern meteorological history.

4. Super Typhoon Ragasa / Nando (September 2025)

- **Track & Scope**: Intensified rapidly into a Category 5-equivalent Super Typhoon over the western North Pacific with sustained winds of 230–265 km/h; swept across the Luzon Strait, Taiwan, Hong Kong, Macau, Guangdong, and northern Vietnam. Known domestically in the Philippines as **Typhoon Nando**.

5. Kamchatka Megathrust Earthquake (30 July 2025 | Russia)

- **Magnitude**: Massive **8.8 Mw earthquake** off the eastern coast of the Kamchatka Peninsula (focal depth 35 km; Intensity IX Violent near Petropavlovsk-Kamchatsky).
- **Historical Benchmark**: The most energetic global earthquake since the 2011 Tohoku event (Japan), tied as the **6th most powerful earthquake in recorded human history** (alongside the 1906 Ecuador-Colombia and 2010 Chile earthquakes).

6. Cyclone Gezani (Madagascar)

- **Impact**: Category 3-equivalent Intense Tropical Cyclone with sustained gusts over 195 km/h made landfall directly at **Toamasina** (Madagascar's chief eastern port city), destroying ~75% of local port and power infrastructure.

High-Yield International Flashpoints & News in Shorts

- **Scotland Legalises Water Cremation (Alkaline Hydrolysis):** Scotland became the **first nation in the UK** to legalize water cremation (alkaline hydrolysis using water, elevated heat, and potassium hydroxide / KOH), marking the most significant funeral law reform since 1902 and reducing greenhouse emissions ~7-fold compared to flame cremation.
- **Spain Bans Social Media for Under-16:** Spain became the **first European country** to prohibit access to social media platforms for children under the age of 16 (second country globally after **Australia**, which enacted a similar ban in December 2025). Announced by PM Pedro Sánchez at the World Government Summit in Dubai.
- **India Gifts High-Speed Ferry to Maldives:** Under the **HICDP Phase III agreement**, India gifted the Maldives its first high-speed ferry, initiating the *Raajje Transport Link (RTL)* inter-island transit network across **Faafu and Dhaalu Atolls** (12 ferries total planned).
- **1st BRICS Sherpas Meeting 2026:** Convened in New Delhi on 9–10 February 2026 under India's BRICS Chairship; led by India's BRICS Sherpa **Sudhakar Dalela** under the theme *"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"*.
- **Pakistan–Afghanistan Escalation (Operation Ghazab lil-Haq):** In late February 2026, Pakistan conducted airstrikes inside Afghanistan designated **Operation Ghazab lil-Haq**, targeting alleged TTP safe havens across the contested **Durand Line** (the 2,640 km frontier drawn in **1893**).

- **BIOFACH 2026 (Nuremberg, Germany) — India "Country of the Year":**
- India was honoured as the official **"Country of the Year"** at BIOFACH 2026 (10–13 February 2026 in Nuremberg), the world's premier organic trade exhibition.
- Participation spearheaded by **APEDA** (Ministry of Commerce & Industry), spotlighting five GI-tagged organic rice varieties: **Indrayani, Navara, Gobindbhog, Red rice, and Chak Hao (Black rice)**.
- *Global Organic Agriculture Matrix*: **Australia** leads the world in total organic farmland area (>53 million hectares); **India ranks 2nd globally in organic agricultural acreage** and ranks **1st globally in the total number of organic producers**. Within India, **Madhya Pradesh ranks 1st in certified organic area**.
- **India Launches e-B-4 Business Visa:** In January 2026, India rolled out the new **e-Production Investment Business Visa (e-B-4)** specifically for Chinese technical specialists and manufacturing engineers to expedite industrial clearances online without embassy visits.
- **Russian Naval Base in Sudan:** Sudan officially ratified an agreement granting Russia rights to build its **first naval logistics base on African soil** near **Port Sudan on the Red Sea**, functioning as a strategic hedge against Mediterranean access constraints at Tartus, Syria.
- **Discovery of 2,000-Year-Old Kushan Coins (Taxila):** Archaeologists discovered bronze coins issued during the reign of Kushan Emperor **Vasudeva I** alongside 6th-century BCE lapis lazuli beads at **Bhir Mound (near Taxila, Rawalpindi, Pakistan)**. Features king making offerings on obverse and a female deity on reverse.
- **Finke River (Australia) — World's Oldest River:** Hydrogeological studies confirmed the **Finke River** (*Larapinta* in Arrernte language; 640 km through MacDonnell Ranges in Central Australia) as the **world's oldest surviving river system**, dating back **300 to 400 million years** as an antecedent stream.
- **India–Netherlands Lothal NMHC Pact:** India and the Netherlands signed an MoU in December 2025 to partner in curating and conserving the **National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC)** at **Lothal, Gujarat**, in institutional collaboration with the National Maritime Museum, Amsterdam.
- **28th Commonwealth Speakers Conference (CSPOC 2026):** India hosted the **28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth** at **Samvidhan Sadan, New Delhi** (14–16 January 2026), chaired by Lok Sabha Speaker **Om Birla** and inaugurated by PM Modi (India previously hosted in 1970–71, 1986, and 2010; 29th CSPOC scheduled for London in 2028).
- **CEC Gyanesh Kumar to Chair International IDEA Council 2026:** India assumed the Chairmanship of the Council of Member States of the **International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance (International IDEA)** for 2026 in Stockholm, Sweden, with Chief Election Commissioner **Gyanesh Kumar** (**26th CEC of India**) serving as Chair.
- **3rd India–Singapore Ministerial Roundtable (ISMR):** Convened in New Delhi on 13 August 2025; India represented by four ministers (Nirmala Sitharaman, Dr. S. Jaishankar, Piyush Goyal, and Ashwini Vaishnaw) alongside Singapore DPM Gan Kim Yong, deepening bilateral digital finance and semiconductor supply chains.
- **California Declares Diwali a State Holiday (2025):** California Governor Gavin Newsom signed into law legislation making Diwali an official paid state holiday, making California the **third U.S. state** to do so after **Pennsylvania** and **Connecticut**.
- **China's CR450 Bullet Train:** China unveiled the **CR450**, achieving test speeds of **453 km/h** to become the world's fastest conventional high-speed train; China operates 45,000 km of high-speed rail.
- **Bulgaria Adopts Euro as 21st Eurozone Member:** On **1 January 2026**, **Bulgaria** formally joined the eurozone, replacing the Bulgarian lev with the euro and becoming the **21st member state of the euro currency bloc** *(Croatia was the 20th member in 2023)*.
- **India–FAO Blue Ports Initiative (September 2025):** MoFPI and Ministry of Fisheries partnered with FAO under PMMSY and FIDF (₹369.80 crore) to convert fishing harbours into climate-smart Blue Ports, selecting **Vanakbara (Diu), Jakhau (Gujarat), and Karaikal (Puducherry)** as initial pilot sites.
- **India Re-Elected to UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC):** In October 2025, India was **elected unopposed to the UNHRC for the 2026–2028 triennium**, securing its **7th term** on the Geneva-based 47-member council.
- **UN Cybercrime Convention Signed in Hanoi:** Under UNODC auspices, member states convened in Hanoi, Vietnam, to sign the **first-ever United Nations Convention Against Cybercrime**, establishing unified global extradition and digital evidence standards.
- **Tuvalu Joins IUCN as 90th Member:** The low-lying Pacific island nation of **Tuvalu** formally acceded as the **90th State Member of the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)** in October 2025.

October 2026

16th BRICS Summit (Kazan, Russia) & Historic India–China LAC Disengagement

What happened The **16th BRICS Summit** was held in **Kazan, Russia** from **22 to 24 October 2026** under the Russian chairship, themed *"Strengthening Multilateralism for Just Global Development and Security"*. The summit culminated in the adoption of the comprehensive **Kazan Declaration**.

The Historic India–China Border Breakthrough - **Patrolling Agreement (21 October):** On the eve of the Kazan summit, India and China finalized a breakthrough diplomatic and military agreement on **patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control (LAC)** in eastern Ladakh. - **Key Friction Points:** Restores patrolling rights and resolves the military standoffs in the critical sub-sectors of **Depsang Plains and Demchok**, establishing ground disengagement protocols that defused the border confrontation persisting since the Galwan clash in May 2020. - **Modi–Xi Bilateral Meeting (23 October):** Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and Chinese President **Xi Jinping** held their **first formal, structured bilateral meeting in five years** on the sidelines in Kazan. - **Key Directives:** Directed the Special Representatives on the Boundary Question (**Ajit Doval** for India and **Wang Yi** for China) and Foreign Ministries to meet early to stabilize overall bilateral ties.

Key BRICS Summit Outcomes - **Partner Country Category:** BRICS officially endorsed and created a new status of **"Partner Countries"** (providing a stepping-stone framework for emerging economies without diluting full member consensus). - **Financial Architecture:** Leaders called for the study of the **BRICS Cross-Border Payment Initiative (BCBPI)**, alternative local-currency settlement mechanisms, and strengthening the New Development Bank (NDB).

> **UPPCS BRICS Venue Alert**

- **16th BRICS Summit (October): Kazan, Russia**.
- **17th BRICS Summit (2025): Rio de Janeiro, Brazil**.
- **18th BRICS Summit (September 2026): Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi (India)**.

23rd SCO Council of Heads of Government Summit | Islamabad, Pakistan (15–16 October 2026)

What happened The **23rd Meeting of the Council of Heads of Government (CHG)** of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) was held in **Islamabad, Pakistan**, chaired by Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif.

Historic Indian Diplomatic Milestone - **Indian Representation:** India was represented by External Affairs Minister **Dr. S. Jaishankar**. - **9-Year Landmark:** Marked the **first visit by an Indian External Affairs Minister to Pakistan in 9 years** (since Sushma Swaraj attended the *Heart of Asia – Istanbul Process* ministerial in Islamabad in December 2015). - **Core Indian Stance:** - Emphasised that regional connectivity initiatives must strictly adhere to the principles of **sovereignty and territorial integrity** (veiled reference to CPEC violating India's sovereignty in PoK). - Reaffirmed zero tolerance against the **"three evils" of terrorism, extremism, and separatism** under the SCO Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS). - Pitched for digital public infrastructure (DPI), affordable healthcare, and climate cooperation within the SCO.

44th & 45th ASEAN Summits & 19th East Asia Summit | Vientiane, Laos

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** attended the **21st ASEAN–India Summit** and the **19th East Asia Summit (EAS)** in **Vientiane, Lao PDR** (under Laos' 2026 ASEAN Chairship, themed *"ASEAN: Enhancing Connectivity and Resilience"*).

Key facts & 10 Years of Act East Policy - **Milestone:** Year 2024–2026 marks **10 years of India's 'Act East' Policy** (launched in 2014 by PM Modi, upgrading the earlier 1991 'Look East' policy). - **10-Point Plan for India–ASEAN Ties:** PM Modi announced a comprehensive 10-point roadmap including: 1. Celebration of **Year of Tourism** between ASEAN and India. 2. Doubling of scholarships at Nalanda University for ASEAN students. 3. Digital connectivity expansion via Digital Public Infrastructure (UPI / fast-payment links). 4. Disaster resilience partnership with the ASEAN Coordinating Centre for Humanitarian Assistance (AHA Centre). 5. Science and green hydrogen research collaboration. - **Review of AITIGA:** Emphasized the timely conclusion of the review of the **ASEAN–India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA)** by 2025–26 to make trade more balanced and resilient.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. With reference to the India–European Union meeting held in January 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Both sides announced that the Free Trade Agreement talks had been concluded.
2. The Free Trade Agreement itself entered into force on 27 January 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Two-statement trap on India–EU January meeting — FTA status vs defence/mobility MoUs. **Ans: D.** Statement 1 is true (talks finished / concluded messaging). Statement 2 is false — entry into force is a later legal step, not automatic on 27 January. Trap: treating “talks concluded” as “already in force”.

Q2. With reference to the India–AI Impact Summit 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It was held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
2. Its three Sutras (pillars) were People, Planet and Progress.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Venue + Sutras of AI Impact Summit; distractors Hyderabad/Mumbai and wrong pillars. **Ans: C.** Both facts are correct. Trap: shifting venue to Hyderabad/Mumbai or replacing Sutras with random tech buzzwords.

Q3. With reference to India–United Kingdom agreements that entered into force on 15 July 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CETA is the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement.
2. DCC is a social-security related Double Contribution Convention.
3. Oman’s trade deal with India, which entered force in June 2026, is also called CETA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: CETA vs DCC — same date, different nature (FTA extra facts). **Ans: A.** (1) and (2) true. (3) false — Oman deal is **CEPA**, not CETA. Trap: using CETA as a generic label for every trade pact.

Q4. With reference to the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Saudi Arabia joined IBCA in May 2026 as its 26th member.
2. Coverage described Saudi Arabia as the first Arab member of IBCA.
3. The IBCA Summit planned for early June 2026 in New Delhi was held exactly on schedule.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: IBCA — Saudi as 26th / first Arab member. **Ans: A.** (1) and (2) true. (3) false — the summit was **rescheduled / postponed**. Trap: assuming every announced summit date was kept.

Q5. With reference to the India–EU leaders' meeting (January 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. António Costa (European Council) and Ursula von der Leyen (European Commission) visited India.
2. India's NDMA signed a disaster-cooperation arrangement with the EU's DG-ECHO.
3. NDMA signed the same arrangement with NATO.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India–EU — NDMA partner and leaders (org / personality trap). **Ans: A.** (3) is the classic wrong partner. Trap: swapping Costa / von der Leyen roles or inserting NATO.

Q6. With reference to WTO Ministerial Conference 14 (MC14), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It was held in Yaoundé, Cameroon.
2. The meeting ended without a big binding deal on several hard issues.
3. India supported pushing the Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD) agreement in the way some members wanted.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: WTO MC14 venue + outcome. **Ans: A.** (3) false — India (with partners such as South Africa in coverage) **opposed** that IFD push. Trap: Geneva as venue.

Q7. With reference to the India–Republic of Korea Summit (April 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Coverage linked the visit with President Lee Jae-myung.
2. Talks stressed semiconductors, shipbuilding and batteries, plus a CEPA review.
3. The India–Korea CEPA first entered force only in 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India–Korea Summit April 2026. **Ans: A.** (3) false — CEPA has been in force since **2010**; 2026 news is **review**. Trap: treating every CEPA headline as a brand-new deal.

Q8. With reference to June 2026 international coverage, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The G7 Summit was hosted by France.
2. Operation Amistad was India's HADR mission for Venezuela using IAF C-17 aircraft in coverage.
3. The G7 Summit was hosted by Italy.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: G7 host + theme; Operation Amistad. **Ans: A.** (3) contradicts (1). Trap: recycling an older G7 host year.

Q9. With reference to June 2026 diplomacy / trade, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. PM Modi received the Guardian of the Blue Horizon honour from Seychelles in coverage.
2. India–Oman CEPA entered into force around early June 2026.
3. India–UK CETA also entered into force in early June 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Seychelles honour + Oman CEPA timing. **Ans: A.** UK CETA is **15 July**. Trap: bundling all trade deals into June.

Q10. With reference to soft West Asia coverage in August 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A roughly 60-day Hormuz reopen understanding was linked with Iran and Oman in coverage.
2. The same understanding was described as a binding UN Security Council resolution already enforced.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Hormuz soft understanding — Iran–Oman. **Ans: D.** Soft IR — do not upgrade MoU-style language into a binding UNSC resolution. Trap: over-legalising soft coverage.

Q11. With reference to the India–AI Impact Summit 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India joined the US-led Pax Silica Declaration on safer critical-mineral / semiconductor / AI infrastructure supply chains.
2. Closing days included GPAI Council meetings in coverage.
3. The summit's three Sutras were Land, Labour and Capital.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Pax Silica + GPAI at AI Summit. **Ans: A.** Sutras are **People, Planet, Progress**. Trap: economics triad as fake Sutras.

Q12. With reference to India–EU January 2026 outcomes, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A Green Hydrogen Task Force was set up.
2. Exploratory talks began on India linking with Horizon Europe.
3. NDMA partnered with NATO for disaster response.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India–EU Green Hydrogen Task Force + Horizon Europe exploratory talks. **Ans: A.** (3) false — partner is **DG-ECHO**.

Q13. With reference to Pax Silica (AI Summit window), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India joined the US-led Pax Silica Declaration.
2. It focuses on safer supply chains for critical minerals, semiconductors and AI infrastructure.
3. It replaces the Paris Agreement.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Pax Silica is supply-chain / critical minerals — not a climate treaty. **Ans: A.** (3) invents a climate-treaty swap.

Q14. Which of the following is/are G7 members?

1. Canada and Japan
2. India and Brazil

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: G7 membership recall. **Ans: D.** India/Brazil are not G7 members. Trap: BRICS confusion.

Q15. With reference to the Islamabad MoU coverage (June 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Pakistan was often named as mediator.
2. IAEA was named in nuclear-monitoring language.
3. It was a binding UNSC Chapter VII resolution.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Islamabad MoU soft IR — mediator Pakistan; IAEA monitoring language. **Ans: A.** (3) over-legalises soft coverage.

Q16. With reference to Operation Amistad, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It was India's HADR mission after earthquakes in Venezuela.
2. Coverage spoke of IAF C-17 Globemaster aircraft.
3. It was a naval blockade of the Caribbean.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Operation Amistad Venezuela HADR. **Ans: A.** (3) invents a military blockade.

Q17. Which honour did PM Modi receive in Uzbekistan (August 2026 coverage)?

A. Order of the White Double Cross B. Order of Oliy Darajali Dustlik C. Bintang Adipurna D. Guardian of the Blue Horizon

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Uzbekistan honour name fact. **Ans: B.** Dustlik = Uzbekistan. Others are Slovakia / Indonesia / Seychelles.

Q18. With reference to the postponed IBCA Summit (June window), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Theme planned: Save Big Cats, Save Humanity, Save Ecosystem.
2. An expected outcome named earlier was a Delhi Declaration.
3. The summit was held exactly on 1–2 June 2026 as first announced.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: IBCA summit theme / Delhi Declaration expectation. **Ans: A.** (3) false — rescheduled.

Q19. With reference to India–Oman CEPA, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It entered into force around early June 2026.

2. Explainers put duty-free access near 99% of Indian export trade value.
3. It is identical to the India–UK CETA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India–Oman CEPA duty-free share idea. **Ans: A.** (3) CEPA ≠ CETA.

Q20. With reference to WTO MC14, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It was only the second WTO ministerial meeting held in Africa in coverage.
2. Venue was Yaoundé, Cameroon.
3. Venue was Nairobi, Kenya.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: WTO MC14 Africa second ministerial. **Ans: A.** (3) wrong African capital.